MONTHLY UPDATE

DR Congo: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration

FINANCE
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ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
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DPI
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TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

INCLUSION
Digital divides

DATA
National statistics · Open data

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

TELECOM INFRASTRUCTURE-SHARING AND TAXATION STUDIES UNDER THE CONNECTIVITY PROJECT

- **PACT et telecoms en RDC : baisse des couts en vue** — Numerico.cd, 9 September 2026

  PACT studies on telecom taxation and infrastructure sharing land in Kinshasa; central infra database urged.

Legislation and regulation

ORDONNANCES-LOIS ORGANISING STATISTICAL ACTIVITY

- **Le Président Tshisekedi fixe les conditions d'organisation de l'activité statistique en RDC - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  Signed text names INS principal statistical authority; secrecy rules bind ongoing operations at once.

- **RDC : le gouvernement adopte le projet de loi autorisant la ratification du nouveau cadre de l'activité statistique** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  Council of 11 Sept 2026; independence and confidentiality principles; statistical data barred from enforcement use.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON NON-CONSENSUAL DIFFUSION OF INTIMATE CONTENT

- **Violence numérique : une proposition de loi de protection des victimes annoncée à Kinshasa - ACP** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 12 September 2026

  Deputy Christelle Vuanga to table bill amending penal and digital codes: 5-10 years for non-consensual intimate images.

DÉCRET 23/13 CREATING THE SUCCESSOR REGULATOR ARPTIC

- **[Enquête]- ARPTC, un policier illégal et défaillant** — Ouragan.cd, 14 September 2026

  A joint press investigation calls DR Congo's telecoms regulator ARPTC unlawful and ineffective, noting that the successor authority created by a 2023 decree has never been installed. It details failings on service quality and equipment approval.

PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL ON THE PROTECTION OF MINORS IN THE DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT

- **Assemblée nationale: le député Alfred Dibandi initie une proposition de loi relative à la protection des mineurs dans l'environnement numérique** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

  Private member's bill filed 21 Sept 2026; tiered rules for under-6s, -11s and -15s; complements the Code du numérique.

BILL AMENDING THE CODE DU NUMÉRIQUE ON MINORS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **DRC Senate Considers Social Media Ban for Children Under 13** — We Are Tech, 1 October 2026

  Admitted 28 Sept 2026: under-13 ban, parental consent 13-15, mandatory age verification; now in committee.

Regional collaboration

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  49 signatory states plus ESA, among them Angola, DR Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda, Tunisia; open licences, FAIR.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

DIGITAL AND PAYMENTS PROGRAMME FOR THE KINSHASA EXPANSION PROJECT

- **Algerian Company INATEL Signs Strategic Agreement for New Kinshasa City Project** — Africa News (DZ), 3 September 2026

  Kinshasa Kia Mona MOU covers payment systems and a technology excellence centre; no value disclosed.

- **Inatel signe un accord strategique pour le projet de nouvelle ville de Kinshasa** — Algerie Eco, 4 September 2026 ALGERIA

  The Algerian state electronics firm INATEL, with PGS Africa and DABYAN, signed a protocol with the coordination of the DRC's Kinshasa expansion project for an integrated digital, industrial and technological programme covering digital technologies, electronic payment systems, digital equipment and services, knowledge transfer and a centre for innovation in payment systems, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence. No amount is stated.

New investments

VODACOM CONGO NETWORK INVESTMENT PROGRAMME

- **RDC : Vodacom veut porter à 670 millions USD ses investissements réseau pour accélérer la transformation numérique** — Zoom Eco, 9 October 2026

  4G at 46.1%, 26.4m subscribers, 10m M-Pesa clients; PM wants state data hosted in the DRC.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

INDEPENDENT TOWER ESTATE

- **RDC : plus de 40 millions de Congolais connectés grâce aux infrastructures de Helios Towers** — ACTUALITE.CD, 4 September 2026

  Helios Towers RDC hits 3,000 sites (3 Sep 2026), 673 rural; claims mobile coverage for 40m+.

KIGOMA-KALEMIE FIBRE ACROSS LAKE TANGANYIKA

- **Tanzania, DRC agree to fast-track SGR link and fibre-optic cable across Lake Tanganyika** — Daily News (Tanzania), 5 September 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania and the DRC agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie across Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The commitment was reaffirmed at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador; no route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published.

GOMA-MOMBASA FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 RWANDA UGANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

INTERNET SERVICE QUALITY IN KINSHASA AND THE REGULATOR'S RESPONSE

- **Connexion Internet à Kinshasa : les consommateurs à bout, les opérateurs interpellés, l'ARPTC sous pression** — Forum des As, 17 September 2026

  Internet subscribers in Kinshasa report slow speeds, frequent interruptions and difficulty reaching online services across all four mobile operators, against the packages they pay for. The regulator is being called on to act.

NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT FIBRE BACKBONE

- **DR Congo plans four 20-year PPPs for 11,600km fibre network** — The PPP Post, 26 September 2026

  Four 20-year concession lots with gap financing; supervision EOI closes 14 Oct 2026, work from June 2027.

HELIOS TOWERS AND UNICEF SCHOOL-CONNECTIVITY PARTNERSHIP (GIGA)

- **Helios Towers partners with UNICEF to accelerate digital inclusion and expand learning opportunities for children across Africa** — UNICEF UK, 28 September 2026 MALAWI TANZANIA

  Multi-year Giga and Learning Passport support, starting in DRC, Malawi and Tanzania; a West African country to follow.

5G COMMERCIAL LAUNCH

- **RDC : le gouvernement annonce le lancement commercial de la 5G** — 7sur7.cd, 11 October 2026

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October, as a new source of state revenue and a way to improve service quality. Deployment is to begin in urban areas; no operator, spectrum assignment or launch date was given.

- **RDC : la 5G en préparation, près de 7 Congolais sur 10 restent hors ligne** — wearetech.africa, 12 October 2026

  DR Congo's government is preparing a commercial 5G launch, which the telecommunications minister said in late September it was working to make available before the end of 2026. The article sets that against internet use of about 30.5% of the population at the end of 2025 and mobile internet coverage of 45%.

FIBRE INTERCONNECTION WITH THE CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR

  The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced.

TELECOMMUNICATIONS CUT IN FIZI TERRITORY AND BARAKA, SOUTH KIVU

- **Sud-Kivu : la société civile exige la réouverture des réseaux de télécommunications coupés depuis 3 mois** — CongoRassure, 13 October 2026

  Civil society in Fizi territory and Baraka, South Kivu, published a memorandum to the President demanding the reopening of telecommunications networks it says have been cut since 3 July 2026. It alleges that soldiers seized satellite kits and phones and that local authorities resold satellite Wi-Fi, and announces a sit-in from 19 October.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 KENYA SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Compute as mini-grid anchor customer; Kenya, DRC, Sierra Leone pilots for about 85,000 people; community load first.

Technical Capacity

DIGITAL EQUIPMENT ASSEMBLY AND PRODUCTION FACILITY AT MALUKU

- **Kinshasa Kia Mona Plans Digital Equipment Assembly Facility** — BANKABLE, 3 September 2026

  MoU of 30 August 2026 for a Maluku assembly plant for POS terminals, ATMs and computers; no sum, no timetable.

IMPLEMENTATION CAPACITY OF THE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA MALAWI ZAMBIA ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA spent 9% of USD 3.71m 2026 budget by June; Angola, DRC, Malawi, Zambia, Eswatini project status.

- **Transformation numérique : le COPIL valide le PTBA 2026 et appelle à accélérer l'exécution du projet** — 7sur7.cd, 10 October 2026

  The steering committee of the DRC's digital transformation project met for the first time on 8 October and approved the 2026 work plan and budget. Members went through delays component by component and set priorities to 2027.

DPI

Data Exchange

REVENUE-AGENCY DATA CROSS-CHECKING UNDER SYSTEMIC CONTROL

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  Monthly VAT above FC320bn from FC280bn; three revenue agencies interconnecting; E-Finance with Huawei over $150m.

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC CERTIFICATION AUTHORITY

- **RDC : stratégies, identité numérique et cybersécurité au bilan d'un an de réformes** — Agence Ecofin, 30 September 2026

  The DRC's digital economy minister said the prime minister had signed decrees creating an online administrative-services portal and a national electronic certification agency, and that a national cybersecurity agency had been created by presidential ordinance. He said the RDC-PASS digital identity entered a first operational phase in September with 50 enrolment agents trained.

NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM AND ITS INTEGRATIONS

- **Africa CDC Deploys Digital Tools, CHEWs To Strengthen Ebola Response In DRC** — Science Nigeria, 2 October 2026

  150+ devices incl. Starlink deployed, 742 more coming; DHIS2 for outbreak data; 71,000 community workers planned.

Digital Identity and CRVS

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Semlex to face criminal trial in Belgium over Congo passport scandal** — Biometric Update, 1 September 2026

  14 face trial in Belgium over $60 diverted from every $185 Congo passport, near $60m total.

- **RDC: Jean-Claude Mputu dénonce la continuité Semlex-RAM** — CongoQuotidien, 2 September 2026

  CNPAV on the never-published 2020 renewal, the USD 185 to USD 100 passport price, and the RAM parallel.

DIASPORA DIGITAL IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **RDC : Haut Conseil, carte Okapi et identification numérique…Crispin Mbadu détaille les réformes en faveur de la diaspora** — 7sur7.cd, 12 September 2026

  OKAPI card for Congolese by origin holding foreign nationality; diaspora digital ID system in development.

- **Diaspora congolaise : lancement à Paris et Bruxelles de la phase pilote de l'identification numérique** — B-one télévision, 30 September 2026

  Pilot opened Paris 27 Sept, Brussels 29 Sept 2026; diaspora.gouv.cd skills register; Carte Okapi for dual nationals.

NATIONAL POPULATION IDENTIFICATION OPERATION

- **RDC : l'identification de la population annoncée pour la mi-décembre 2026** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  98th Council of Ministers set mid-December 2026 for the start of ONIP population identification.

- **RDC : ce qu'il faut retenir de l'identification de la population et du recensement général de la population** — Beto.cd, 13 September 2026

  Two administrations will count Congolese in parallel while the data protection authority is not installed.

OKAPI CARD FOR CONGOLESE BY ORIGIN HOLDING ANOTHER NATIONALITY

- **RDC : Haut Conseil, carte Okapi et identification numérique…Crispin Mbadu détaille les réformes en faveur de la diaspora** — 7sur7.cd, 12 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

RDC-PASS NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY PLATFORM

- **RDC : plus de 9 000 candidats pour RDC Pass** — Digital Business Africa, 14 September 2026

  DR Congo's digital economy ministry said more than 9,000 candidates sat the recruitment test for RDC Pass agents and a first cohort of 50 was retained for the Kinshasa pilot. Training starts on 15 September, followed by extension to other Kinshasa zones and then nationwide.

- **RDC-Pass : lancement de la formation des 50 premiers agents d'enregistrement** — 7sur7.cd, 16 September 2026

  DR Congo began training the first 50 enrolment agents for its RDC-Pass digital identity platform on 15 September 2026, three months after its launch. The digital economy minister said RDC-Pass is an authentication tool, not a national identity card, and does not replace civil registration.

- **RDC : le projet d'identification numérique RDC-Pass entre dans sa phase opérationnelle** — wearetech.africa, 17 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's RDC-Pass digital identity project entered its first implementation phase three months after launch, with training for 50 registration agents opening in Kinshasa on 15 September. The identifier is intended to work across several administrations and reduce the number of separate identification systems.

POPULATION IDENTIFICATION ROADMAP

- **RDC : l'ONIP réaffirme son engagement en faveur d'un système national sécurisé d'identification** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 17 September 2026

  ONIP says collection for the national population identification system starts December 2026.

Digital Payments and Fintech

ROADMAP FOR MODERNISING THE NATIONAL PAYMENTS SYSTEM

- **Le pari de la Banque centrale pour moderniser le système de paiements** — Ouragan, 4 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Congo instructed its technical services to draw up a roadmap for modernising the national payments system, its governor said after a central bank payments conference in Istanbul. The stated aims are the security, fluidity and continuity of transactions and assessing the uses and risks of artificial intelligence, tokenisation, stablecoins and central bank digital currencies; the delegation gave sustained attention to offline payment, given electricity and internet constraints in several parts of the country.

ISYS-REGIES REVENUE COLLECTION PLATFORM

- **Presumee cyber-maffia a la Banque Centrale sur les recettes de la DGI : versions croisees** — Congo Guardian, 10 September 2026

  DGI letter of 3 September alleges revenue siphoning via ISYS-REGIES; BCC's 10 September reply denies any tampering.

- **RDC : la BCC dement toute manipulation des recettes de l'Etat et clarifie les ecarts entre Isys-regies et Navision** — Actualite.cd, 11 September 2026

  Dates ISYS-REGIES to a 2021 AFD-backed build and a 12.5m euro 2021 convention behind the revenue chain.

MICROFINANCE TRANSITION TO DIGITAL PAYMENTS

- **DRC Microfinance Institutions Seek Digital Support Ahead of Dollar Cash Ban** — BANKABLE, 14 September 2026

  Microfinance bodies seek support before the central bank's 2027-04-09 ban on US dollar cash transactions.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (PAPSS) ACCESSION

- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

  DR Congo joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System on 18 September 2026, when the central bank governor, André Wameso, signed the accession agreement in Nairobi. The same day he signed the East African Community central banks' memorandum on currency convertibility and repatriation, which Burundi, Uganda, Tanzania, Kenya and South Sudan had already joined.

NATIONAL CONSUMER COMPLAINTS PLATFORM

- **Communiqué de presse N°163/2026 : le Ministère de l'Économie Nationale lance « LOBA », une plateforme numérique dédiée à la protection des consommateurs** — Ministère de l'Économie Nationale (RDC), Cellule de communication, 5 October 2026

  National launch 6 October 2026; COMCO with sector regulators; WhatsApp chatbot and mobile app; complaint tracking.

Registries

NATIONAL QR-CODE PRODUCT TRACEABILITY AND CERTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **DRC to Roll Out QR Code System to Track Products and Fight Counterfeits** — We are Tech (wearetech.africa), 7 September 2026

The Democratic Republic of the Congo's standards control office plans a national QR-code system letting consumers scan a product — medicines included — to verify its certification status, with consumer checks stated as opening within weeks and resting on 88 laboratories across 29 sites. No launch date, register or enforcement route is published.

SINGLE UNIQUE IDENTIFIER FOR BUSINESSES

- **RDC : Félix Tshisekedi veut instaurer un identifiant numérique unique pour les entreprises** — numerico.cd, 29 September 2026

  99th Council of Ministers, 25 Sep: three-month deadline; interoperable systems, harmonised texts, report due.

LOI 25-062 ON THE LAND AND PROPERTY REGIME

- **RDC : l'apport de la digitalisation du secteur foncier présenté à Kinshasa** — ACP, 8 October 2026

  The DRC's land affairs minister said implementation of the December 2025 land law has begun: digitisation directorates created and more than 350 officials trained in archiving. Three of Kinshasa's nine land districts are in the first phase, toward a geolocated digital cadastre.

Sectoral management information systems

ANONYMISED MOBILE-PHONE DATA IN OUTBREAK RESPONSE

- **Health officials turn to mobile-phone data to track Ebola spread in Congo** — Reuters, 3 September 2026

  First use of anonymised call records in an Ebola response; the data flagged Kisangani before cases appeared.

FACTURE NORMALISÉE (STANDARDISED VAT E-INVOICING SYSTEM)

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

- **RDC/Impôt : la DGI déploie un contrôle rigoureux de la facture normalisée après la fin du moratoire** — Magazine RD CONGO-MONDE, 9 October 2026

  The DRC's tax directorate began nationwide checks of the standardised invoice on 5 October, after the moratorium ended. Consumers are asked to verify invoices by QR code in the official application, with rewards for verified reports of non-compliance.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYGREM MULTIMODAL FREIGHT-CHARGE MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

- **Lancement officiel de la plateforme SYGREM par le VPM Jean Pierre Bemba fruit du partenariat entre l'OGEFREM et PADS Corporation** — Ministere des Transports RDC, 2 September 2026

  Ogefrem and PADS digitise the FERI, AD and FERE freight documents with geolocation and online payment.

E-FINANCE DIGITAL PUBLIC-FINANCE PROGRAMME

- **RDC : les recettes mensuelles de la TVA passent de 123,7 à plus de 141,4 millions $ grâce aux réformes fiscales (Doudou Fwamba)** — 7sur7.cd, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

GUICHET UNIQUE INTEGRAL DU COMMERCE EXTERIEUR (GUICE)

- **RDC : Julien Paluku vante la dématérialisation des procédures commerciales pour lutter contre la corruption** — DeskNews, 17 September 2026

  93 of 98 foreign-trade documents dematerialised; the single window is now wired to customs' SYDONIA World.

- **SEGUCE RDC poursuit le deploiement du GUICE et rapproche les services du commerce exterieur des operateurs economiques du Kasai Oriental** — ACTUALITE.CD, 17 September 2026

  The concessionaire running DR Congo's integrated foreign-trade single window took it to Mbuji-Mayi in Kasai Oriental, presenting its services to provincial authorities, the administrations concerned and local traders and hearing their concerns. Its director general framed provincial establishment as territorial equity, the window being a national instrument.

GUICHET NUMÉRIQUE (ONLINE ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES WINDOW)

- **RDC : stratégies, identité numérique et cybersécurité au bilan d'un an de réformes** — Agence Ecofin, 30 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

ELECTORAL COMMISSION ELECTRONIC DOCUMENT MANAGEMENT

- **CENI : Denis Kadima lance la numérisation des archives et la formation de 762 cadres et agents** — Dépêche.cd, 1 October 2026

  Archives since 2005 into one secure repository; 762 staff trained in four phases, AI in the syllabus.

INTEGRATED ELECTRONIC-VISA PLATFORM

- **RDC : Kinshasa accélère la mise en œuvre du visa électronique afin de moderniser le traitement des demandes via un système numérique** — Ecomine, 14 October 2026

  Foreign and digital economy ministers meet 14 Oct 2026; centralised visa processing, no timetable or technical detail.

Technology

AI

CENTRAL BANK POSITION ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **André Wameso à Nairobi : Quand la BCC plaide pour une intelligence artificielle au service des Banques centrales africaines** — Magazine RD Congo-Monde, 18 September 2026

  Four AI workstreams for the BCC, and an internal audit of the financial ecosystem before any major deployment.

AVAILABILITY OF ANTHROPIC'S CLAUDE

- **RDC : Claude, l'assistant d'IA d'Anthropic, désormais officiellement accessible** — wearetech.africa, 23 September 2026

  DR Congo's Ministry of Digital Economy announced on 22 September that Anthropic's Claude is now officially available in the country, both the consumer service and commercial API access. Users had previously reached it through VPNs; the communiqué gave no terms.

PUBLIC AWARENESS OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Intelligence artificielle en RDC : la notoriété progresse, les usages s'accélèrent [Target]** — globalnewsrdc, 6 October 2026

  AI awareness 54% to 61%, use 24% to 47% (2025-26); 2,280 respondents; gender and regional gaps; ChatGPT leads.

Innovation ecosystem

COPA DIGITAL GRANT COMPETITION

- **Entrepreneuriat numérique en RDC : TRANSFORME et le PTN préparent le COPA Digital avec l'appui de la Banque mondiale** — TRANSFORME (UCP), 18 September 2026

  PTN and TRANSFORME sign 2026-09-18 protocol; 16-month pilot, grant sizes and eligibility not yet published.

KINSHASA TECHNOPARK AND SOVEREIGN DATA CENTRE PROJECT

- **Transformation numérique : Augustin Kibassa Maliba s'inspire du modèle Skolkovo pour le futur Technopark de Kinshasa** — Actu7.cd, 8 October 2026

  The DRC's digital economy minister visited the Skolkovo innovation centre near Moscow as a model for a technology park and sovereign data centre planned for Kinshasa's extension zone. No site, cost or timetable is given.

Inclusion

Digital divides

LOW-TECHNOLOGY REMOTE LEARNING IN EBOLA HIGH-RISK AREAS

- **Année scolaire 2026-2027 : Une reprise effective des cours sur toute l'étendue du territoire national malgré les défis sécuritaires et sanitaires** — MINEDU-NC RDC, 3 September 2026

  Light distance learning by worksheet and radio for 18 Ebola high-risk sub-divisions, no internet needed.

UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND PILOT SITES

- **Connectivité : la RDC explore des solutions abordables pour étendre le réseau** — Agence Ecofin, 13 October 2026

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications ministry is promoting solar-powered microsites to extend mobile coverage to rural and peri-urban areas, presented to the universal service fund and four operators. Fifty pilot sites are planned, each said to cost a quarter of a conventional mast.

Data

National statistics

SECOND GENERAL POPULATION AND HOUSING CENSUS

- **Opérations de la cartographie en cours d'opérationnalisation en RDC** — Radio Okapi, 1 September 2026

  The cartography phase of the DRC's second population census is being operationalised with digital tools and satellite imagery, the central census bureau's technical coordinator said — 42 years after the country's only previous census, in 1984.

- **Recensement, identification et enrôlement en RDC : ce qu'il faut savoir** — 7sur7.cd, 1 October 2026

  Census counts, identification issues ID cards; RGPH-2 costed USD 192m, enumeration July 2027, ends late 2027.

Open data

NATIONAL POLICY ON THE MANAGEMENT AND SECURITY OF ENVIRONMENTAL DATA

- **RDC : alerte sur l'urgence d'élaborer une politique de gestion des données environnementales** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 6 September 2026

  ACCOS study: over 125 synoptic weather stations and 400 hydrometric stations in the 1960s, few still working.

STATE CONTROL OF GEOLOGICAL DATA

- **Congo extends state control over mining with bid to lock down geological data** — The Citizen, 8 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo is vesting its geological data in the state and charging for access, extending state control over mining; a resource-governance institute questions whether release will be even-handed.

NATIONAL GEOLOGICAL DATA BANK

- **Regulation of the mineral and raw materials sector in the DRC: measures to expand state control and ensure the preservation of geological data** — The Port Brief, 13 September 2026

  Kinshasa is digitising geological archives into a national mineral data bank to expand state control.

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